

Amazon Interview Experience

Hiring Process Overview:

- 1) An online coding contest on the HackerRank platform
- 2) Interview Round 1 (Focused on DSA & Problem Solving) – Conducted online

HackerRank Online Round Experience:

I was given 2 coding questions from the pool of 6-8 to be solved in 70 min.

1) Binary Search on Answer

Given an array of length n (representing the number of delivery persons), where each index indicates the current number of orders assigned to each person, and an integer k representing additional orders to be distributed among them.

Minimize the maximum number of orders any person will have after distributing the additional orders.

$$1 \leq n, k \leq 1e5;$$

2) Ad-Hoc problem

Given three vectors of the same length n (representing the number of people), each index in these vectors corresponds to the three different powers each person possesses. In a tournament, every person competes against every other person. Each match consists of three rounds, where the participants can use their powers in any order. A person is declared the winner of a match if they win at least two out of the three rounds. A round is won if the power used by a person is strictly greater than their opponent's power for that round.

For example, if person1 has powers $[7, 4, 3]$ and person2 has powers $[6, 5, 2]$, both can win depending on the permutation of powers they choose. However, if person1 has powers $[10, 9, 2]$ and person2 has powers $[4, 3, 1]$, person2 cannot win in any permutation.

Return a boolean vector of size n , where each value indicates whether a person can win every match against all other participants.

$$2 \leq n \leq 1e5;$$

After the online test, you were directed to behavioral questions, which play a crucial role in the selection process.

Out of over 1100 participants, 85 students were shortlisted.

Interview Round 1 (DSA Round):

1) Given an array that represents the number of tools needed, along with "k" representing the total available tools, we need to distribute the tools sequentially in a circular manner. Return the index at which the tools run out.

$1 \leq k \leq 10^9$;

2) <https://leetcode.com/problems/possible-bipartition/description/>

Finally 15 students were selected.

Must Do in Coding interview:

1) Think out Loud: Articulate your thought process and reasoning during problem-solving to keep the interviewer engaged and to clearly communicate your approach.

2) Understand the Crux of the problem: Before jumping into the solution, make sure you fully grasp the problem by asking any needed clarifying questions. Make observations from the problem

3) Approach: Start with a Brute-Force Solution. Discuss the brute-force approach initially to show you can identify a basic starting point. Then, work on optimizing the solution if possible.

General Preparation Tips:

When practicing coding questions, start with daily problems on [LeetCode](https://leetcode.com/) and gradually transition to competitive programming sites like [CodeForces](https://codeforces.com/). Instead of relying solely on YouTube tutorials, focus on learning from problem editorials. Use SDE sheets primarily for revision rather than as your primary resource. Understand how much time to allocate to a specific problem, and make sure to consistently participate in contests to improve your rating and time management skills. Above all, maintain consistency in your practice.

All the best.

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